Playable Peoples of Aetheln

Document Status

This is the canonical anatomy, visual identity, cultural-heritage, character creation, animation, and equipment-presentation reference for the playable peoples of Aetheln.

The Game Design Bible governs high-level product behavior. This document governs playable-people detail. Characters, settlements, classes, factions, progression, and technical architecture remain governed by their specialized canonical documents.

Shared Canon

The three confirmed playable peoples are Aurin, Kell, and Vesh.

- The Waking Star dreamed each people separately into existence.
- All three peoples predate the Duskbreak. No confirmed account identifies which people was dreamed first.
- Aurin, Kell, and Vesh are distinct biologies and do not produce biological hybrids with one another. Cross-people families form through partnership, adoption, and chosen kinship.
- Each people maintains heritage languages alongside a shared common language.
- Every playable people supports male and female adult characters across a broad visible age range.
- Every people and sex may use every supported class and join either player faction.
- Race, sex, body, age, face, voice, and other appearance choices never change attributes, combat power, collision, reach, traces, timing, readable telegraphs, loot probability, or progression.
- All people use a narrow, overlapping visual-height range and broad curated body presets, including lean, soft, muscular, and heavy-set directions.
- Male and female presentations must read as clearly distinct within each people while retaining broad overlap in height, build, age presentation, and voice. Sex-linked face, body, and secondary-anatomy anchors are defined below and remain inside the shared combat envelope.

Visual designs must not reduce the peoples to renamed stock fantasy races, animal heads on humanoid bodies, or extreme playable size classes.

Culture, Faction, and Individual Identity

Each people has recognizable heritage materials, motifs, naming traditions, and movement language. Those roots do not prescribe personality, profession, class, homeland, or faction.

Each people's heritage identity carries a stable semantic ID with a working display name (Issue #104): Aurin use `heritage.menders_brace` (Mender's Brace), Kell use `heritage.memory_nail` (Memory Nail), and Vesh use `heritage.foreseen_path` (Guided Path). The Vesh working display name replaces Foreseen Path; the stable ID is unchanged. IDs remain stable when display names change. Heritage is narrative and presentation identity only; it never changes combat statistics, hitboxes, reach, timing, or loot.

- Aurin are not biologically aligned with the Crowned Ledger (the provisional faction display name superseding Dawn Concordat under Issue #104).
- Kell are not biologically aligned with the Hundred Witnesses (superseding Unbound Flame under Issue #104).
- Vesh are not biologically neutral.
- Any people may live within, inherit, learn, or wear another people's culture.
- Cultural equipment and cosmetics must have fitted visual variants for every supported people and sex.
- Faction identity must come from explicit faction heraldry, clothing, objectives, territory, Doctrine, and story presentation rather than anatomy.

Aurin

Approved Design Record

On 2026-10-10 the user selected the male Aurin v06 and female Aurin v13 as the updated race visual baseline. The male has a sturdy muscular athletic build, dark curls with gray, a short beard, and simplified mature facial planes. The female has an athletic feminine build with a fuller chest, defined waist and hips, a softer feminine face, and a neck-length dark bob. Both use natural Human anatomy and the polished stylized 3D sculpt finish in the Art Style and Generation Guide.

These are full-body frontal A-pose anatomy references, wearing plain charcoal modeling clothing rather than armor: shorts for the male; a short-sleeved crop top and knee-length pants for the female. Their clothing, individual faces, hairstyles, and builds are reference choices, not limits on Aurin customization or replacements for the heritage clothing language below. The broader Human appearance range and shared combat rules remain in force.

The approval and provenance record preserves the selected versions, exact prompts, and image identities. Earlier Aurin studies are historical references. Image approval does not establish a mesh, rig, equipment fit, or runtime acceptance.

Identity and Anatomy

Aurin are the human people of Aetheln. "Human" is an out-of-world explanatory term; people in Aetheln call them Aurin.

Aurin use fully human anatomy and the full natural range of human skin tones, hair colors, hair textures, faces, builds, and visible aging. They have no innate glow, glass, Ember mark, mutation, or supernatural organ. Individual magic exposure, injury, scars, cosmetics, and Duskbreak effects remain individual conditions rather than Aurin biology.

Male and female Aurin use clearly distinct base human face, torso-form, fat-distribution, and musculature directions across overlapping heights and limb lengths. Every sex still supports the full curated body-preset, age-presentation, and voice ranges.

Visual Language

Aurin should feel resilient and burdened rather than pristine or generically heroic.

- **Materials:** maintained steel, dark wood, heavy woven cloth, visible mending, and inherited pieces.
- **Motifs:** repaired lines, joined breaks, reinforced seams, layered borders, and tally marks used for family records, vows, debts, or survival counts.
- **Heritage palette:** charcoal, iron, rust-red Ember warmth, and restrained gold light.
- **Clothing silhouette:** layered workwear with structured shoulders, wrapped waists, overlapping panels, and visible repairs.
- **Markings:** the full range of human scars, tattoos, paint, cosmetic pigments, ritual marks, and natural features.

These are heritage defaults, not compulsory clothing or a faction uniform.

Culture, Names, and Motion

Aurin cultures argue over whether survival means repairing inherited systems or dismantling them to build something genuinely new.

Aurin heritage names are grounded and familiar. Flowing given names such as Kaelen, Serra, and Aldrec may pair with terse lineage, place, or trade surnames such as Dross, Vale, and Fane.

Aurin movement is grounded and purposeful. Weight settles clearly, gestures conserve effort, and actions appear practiced. This movement identity is presentation only and does not change gameplay timing.

Aurin voices cover a broad human range. Accent and vocal character may express region and culture independently from faction or class.

Kell

Approved Design Record

On 2026-10-10 the user selected male Kell image 57 and female Kell image 59 as the new Kell. These are the canonical visual baseline for the race. Use the Art Style and Generation Guide for their polished 3D rendering finish.

This revision replaces the former living-skin body with its localized mineral frame, crown, and shoulder mantle. It is a revision of the race's design and history, not a transformation that every Kell underwent during the Duskbreak. Earlier studies, prompts, and reviews retain their historical meaning but no longer define Kell anatomy. The selected front concepts approve the design direction; the production validation gate below still applies.

Identity and Anatomy

Kell are living crystalline people. Pale ivory quartz grows in overlapping, curved anatomical plates over a deeper network of smoky amethyst crystal. Both layers are living parts of the body. The darker interior connects the neck, torso, limbs, and joints, allowing the layered form to articulate. Kell are born, grow, age, and die; their mineral appearance does not make them manufactured constructs or animated deposits of ore.

Required Kell anatomy includes:

- an expressive face with sculpted brow, cheek, and jaw planes, a broad low flat nose, and a defined mouth;
- glowing violet eyes with readable eye contours;
- long external pointed ears with dark crystal accents;
- paired swept quartz horns rooted above the temples, curving outward and back, with dark amethyst insets;
- amethyst accents at the forehead, temples, cheeks, and inner ears;
- flowing quartz plates across the torso and limbs, with darker crystal bands visible between them;
- articulated clawed hands with an opposable thumb and usable weapon grips; and
- grounded feet with a heel and three articulated forward toes ending in quartz claws.

Kell are hairless. Their head remains expressive and compact enough for fitted helmets; it has neither an animal muzzle nor a separate oversized crown. The neck is substantial but allows a readable collar and shoulder line. Hands and feet stay balanced with the body. Horns, ears, plate contours, and claws remain inside the shared presentation bounds and do not expand combat collision.

The approved baseline uses pale ivory outer quartz and dark smoky violet amethyst beneath it. Sparse mineral veins and controlled facets enrich broad, smooth forms. The interior has restrained local radiance, and the eyes glow more clearly. These are ordinary Kell anatomy, not Ember attunement, a power resource, or a combat-state signal. Alternate mineral families and glow hues are not established by the earlier exploration; their availability remains TBD.

Living plates are biological surfaces, not equipped armor. Horns, claws, and crystal light grant no racial damage, defense, detection, healing, or other gameplay advantage. Exact hand digit topology and grip deformation remain production TBDs to resolve from the selected concepts and shared weapon-grip tests, rather than carrying forward the former five-digit requirement.

Sex, Age, and Variation

The selected male has a broader chest, shoulders, and jaw with moderately full musculature. The selected female has less muscle bulk, a softer brow and jaw, and an athletic feminine torso and waist-to-hip transition. Both share the same horn family, external ears, layered construction, glowing eyes, and clawed extremities. Sex differences do not require separate incompatible horn or plate systems. Each sex retains broad body-preset, age, and voice ranges within the same visual scale, limb reach, and combat envelope.

Face presets may vary the brow, cheeks, jaw, mouth, and low nasal planes while retaining the Kell anchors. Horn form, plate pattern, surface tones, finish, and wear provide variation without replacing the living layered structure.

Kell are very long-lived and may span several Aurin generations, but they are not immortal. Exact lifespan years remain TBD. Growth and ordinary healing renew living crystal; older surfaces carry inclusions, softened edges, fine chips, and repair seams. Aging does not continually enlarge the body, horns, or combat silhouette. Mineral renewal is a description of life over time, not an accelerated combat-regeneration ability.

Underlying anatomy remains balanced, with natural asymmetry from life and repair. Voluntary surface engraving and inlay may record personal history; they are cosmetic practices, not compulsory marks or sources of power.

Visual Language

Kell should feel like living geology shaped into a graceful, powerful body. Sweeping plate curves and dark crystalline connections distinguish their silhouette while keeping face, gestures, and emotion readable.

- **Materials:** satin quartz, deep amethyst, maintained dark metal, woven cloth, crafted memory glass, and selective inlay.
- **Motifs:** overlapping growth lines, joined fractures, and a visible seam allowed to remain after repair.

- **Heritage palette:** ivory, smoky violet, charcoal, deep umber, and restrained warm-metal accents. Biological color does not indicate faction.
- **Clothing silhouette:** fitted collars, articulated layers, and clean shoulder shapes that follow the body without obscuring its construction.

Armor remains separate wearable equipment, with accommodations for horns, ears, plates, hands, and feet. Legendary suits may frame the body with stronger shapes and controlled light while preserving fit and combat readability.

Origin, Renewal, and Memory

The Waking Star dreamed the Kell as living crystal, separately from the Aurin and Vesh. The first Kell awakened among the quartz-bearing depths of the canyon that became Graefell, before the Duskbreak. No account establishes which people the Star dreamed first. Ordinary Kell life continues through generations; the race does not depend on fresh catastrophes to create its people.

Kell experience continuity through changing material. A repaired surface can remain visibly different while the person is still whole. A long life therefore leaves a succession of joined layers rather than a perfectly preserved original form. Care, craft, and remembrance are intertwined in their heritage: keeping something alive requires tending it, and tending it may require accepting change.

Kell cultures argue over whether every memory must be preserved or whether forgetting, privacy, and release are necessary for life. Some treat every seam as a debt to the past. Others deliberately leave a repair undecorated or refuse to name what caused it. Neither practice describes all Kell or determines a person's faction.

Their bodies show growth and injury, not readable recordings of thoughts, ancestry, or other people's lives. Memory preservation remains learned craft using tools, vessels, and study, open to all peoples. A crafted archive is distinct from its keeper's living body. The Memory Nail heritage represents the deliberate act of marking what one chooses to carry forward; it does not make memories biological property or grant an innate power.

The Duskbreak confronted Kell with crystal's opposite promise: entire places fixed into inert glass while their living histories were torn apart. Their continued life did not prove that their archives, families, or knowledge were safe. Graefell's arguments about ownership became arguments about care: who may preserve a memory, who must maintain it, and who may consent to its release?

Names and Motion

Kell heritage names are resonant and weighty. Names such as Corvath and Vothram favor deep consonants and held internal rhythms without requiring one repeated suffix.

Kell movement has deliberate weight transfer and fluid articulation between overlapping forms. Posture and easing convey substance without making them rigid or slow to respond. Startup, contact, recovery, root motion, and travel timing remain identical to the shared gameplay source.

Kell voices support broad pitch and character choices with subtle mineral resonance rather than one fixed vocal archetype.

Corvath's Exception

Corvath is a unique living-glass Kell created by the Duskbreak. His silhouette retains the Kell facial, horn, ear, and limb structure, but his whole body is living catastrophe glass rather than renewing quartz plates and amethyst connections. His creation and preservation of conscious dying people are exceptions, not ordinary Kell birth, mineral renewal, or memory craft. His complete material state is not a heritable subtype or a player appearance.

Vothram forged the instruments used to cause the Duskbreak, confirming that Kell existed before the catastrophe. Graefell's first Kell awakening therefore predates the canyon's later glassing.

Vesh

Design Record

The 2026-10-10 redesign replaces the former dream-veiled identity with embodied spirit creatures who follow the Light's guidance. This is a revision of the people's canonical history, not a recent transformation caused by the Duskbreak.

On 2026-10-13 the user adopted the creature exploration as the Vesh race baseline: male v36 and female v37. The female is the image attached to that selection, with the swept white mane and longer nape. The approval record preserves the chosen pair, exact prompts, hashes, and regeneration guidance. Both are approved visual references; production validation remains separate. They supersede the mouthless, solid-footed 2026-10-10 pair and earlier back-veil studies. Their adoption retains the embodied-spirit origin and Light-guided culture below; it is not a transformation event in the world's history.

Origin and Embodied Life

The Waking Star dreamed the Vesh as spirits with lives and physical forms of their own, separately from Aurin and Kell before the Duskbreak. Their first communities gathered where the light held a place's living history together. They learned to attend to the presences carried by its waters, paths, groves, homes, and remembered lives. No confirmed account establishes which people the Star dreamed first.

Vesh describe their bodies as light that has learned to remain. That light holds a tangible, mortal form: it can be touched, injured, clothed, and cared for. They grow within families, age, and die. Their peoplehood is not created by possessing another creature or recalling a deceased Aurin or Kell.

Their spiritual kinship is part of their identity, while listening well is a practice learned through experience, ritual, and consent. An encounter does not give a listener every history a spirit carries. Other peoples can learn to meet and interpret these presences; Vesh heritage grants no exclusive right to speak for them.

The world cosmology defines spirits as bounded local continuities, distinct from Wardens, Embers, and Forgettings. Neither Vesh identity nor spirit contact supplies innate damage, defense, healing, detection, prophecy, flight, incorporeality, or resurrection. Ember attunement remains a separate relationship. Nhalen's severance does not erase his Vesh identity, and ordinary spirit testimony cannot replace the witnessed record used by the Emberbound's shared restoration rules.

Identity and Anatomy

The selected design has an athletic, recognizably humanoid creature silhouette, a modest forward shoulder set, a visible neck, and a natural geometric face. Keep the upper back compact enough to accommodate armor rather than enlarging it into a pronounced hump. Its required visual anatomy includes:

- an obsidian-black short velvety coat with clean white markings;
- white throat, paired upper-chest fields divided by a dark central V, outer shoulder and arm markings, forearm tufts, flanks, outer thighs, and calves; the central abdomen remains dark;
- an ivory-gray rigid face grown as part of the body, with broad clean facets, dark lateral cheeks, a tapered chin, and no human face beneath it;
- two narrow golden-yellow luminous eyes, with no visible human eye whites;
- a restrained, nearly horizontal dark mouth opening with softly rounded ends and a neutral resting expression; no visible teeth, human lips, nose, or muzzle;
- white creature hair in compact sculpted clumps: a short spiky male mane and a swept female mane extending farther down the nape, with the neck visible; these examples do not prescribe every hairstyle;
- clawed hands with two elongated fingers and one opposable thumb; and
- digitigrade legs with raised hocks and three-toed clawed paws.

The face is biological identity rather than a removable mask or equipment. Its planes may vary within the same design family; eye angle, brow, cheeks, and jaw retain the rigid face's identity around the creature mouth. Speech retains its subtly harmonic resonance through the body and face. Mouth movement, eye expression, head inclination, posture, and gesture carry expression. Preserve the rigid facial planes when animating the mouth; detailed jaw deformation and physiology remain TBD rather than implying a human face beneath the surface.

White markings are fur pigment, not glowing veins or separate luminous organs. Keep emission localized to the golden eyes. The dark coat remains close and smooth; white markings form broad, overlapping sculpted fur clumps, with longer accents around the head, shoulders, forearms, outer thighs, and calves. Keep detail restrained and readable as fur rather than feathers, scales, or armor. There are no biological wings, back-veils, horns, tails, muzzles, or animal ears. The art guide governs the polished 3D finish.

Sex, Age, and Variation

The approved male uses an athletic masculine build, broader shoulders and chest, and a stronger facial contour. The approved female uses a slim athletic feminine build, gentler waist-to-hip transitions, a softer jaw and cheek contour, and balanced smaller-looking hands and paws. Both must fit the shared visual scale, limb-reach bounds, combat envelope, and broad body-preset range.

Both sexes retain the same face material, creature mouth, golden eyes, short coat, white marking language, clawed hand topology, and digitigrade paws. Hair, face, body, voice, and marking presets provide individual variation; exact supported choices remain TBD.

Vesh live moderately longer than Aurin without approaching Kell longevity. Exact years remain TBD. Age appears through changes in hair and coat texture, subtle wear on the natural face, posture, and voice. Their inner coherence can be wounded, but aging does not make their bodies transparent or change their combat surface.

Following the Light

Vesh heritage calls its practice the Guided Path, retaining the stable ID `heritage.foreseen_path`. A guide asks a listener to notice a life or place that needs care; the listener must still choose a response. The Light is understood as a call toward clarity, compassion, and renewal. It is not a law spoken in a single voice, and a Vesh cannot claim certainty about the Waking Star's intent.

Enlightenment is an ongoing discipline. A listener first quiets personal wants, hears a presence without demanding agreement, compares its account with other witnesses, and accepts responsibility for acting under uncertainty. A spirit may remain silent, depart, remember wrongly, or ask for release rather than preservation. Listening creates a duty of care rather than ownership.

Families and traveling circles keep shared lantern vigils: they gather living witnesses and willing spirits, remember specific names, and leave room for accounts that do not agree. Apprentices accompany experienced keepers on pilgrimages before conducting their own. These practices are open to other peoples and are not a substitute for Order training or faction choice.

Their cultural dispute is whether guidance imposes an obligation that must be followed or a question that must be weighed against other duties. The first position can become obedience to a charismatic interpreter; the second can become an excuse never to act. Individuals can be generous, vain, uncertain, non-observant, or coercive. Spiritual identity does not guarantee moral purity.

Vesh in the Crowned Ledger argue that accountable records and common law protect fragile witnesses. Vesh in the Hundred Witnesses argue that a community and its spirits must retain the right to speak or leave. Each can follow the Light while disputing the other's method. Neither faction owns its guidance.

Visual Language, Names, and Motion

- **Materials:** dark woven cloth, pale carved wood, satin ivory fittings, translucent lantern resin, and restrained golden luminous thread.
- **Motifs:** branching paths that meet without merging, open lantern frames, and nested arcs that leave space around a central light.
- **Heritage palette:** obsidian, white, ivory, and small lantern-gold accents.
- **Clothing silhouette:** light layered robes, fitted traveling clothes, supple wraps, and shaped armor that frame the face and accommodate hair and fur, clawed hands, and digitigrade legs. The approved pair are unarmored anatomy references with opaque fur coverage, not heritage uniforms.

Vesh heritage names remain soft and echoing. Nhalen and Saeril favor breathy openings, liquid consonants, and paired vowels. Chosen titles remember an act, journey, or guiding encounter rather than claiming spiritual rank over others.

Their movement is composed and attentive, with deliberate head turns, flowing transitions, and restrained hair and fur follow-through. Voice and movement identity retain the shared attack contact, recovery, and telegraph rules.

Selaen, Lanternrest, and the Quieting

Selaen remains an airborne convoy suspended and steered by resonant lantern engines riding observed Ember currents. Learned observation and fallible spirit guidance inform routes; no encounter guarantees safe passage. Routine travel consumes neither captive spirits nor captured Star-light, and Vesh bodies cannot fly. Its caravans carry supplies, witnesses, and records between places.

Mother-Lanterns are constructed semi-living meeting vessels where willing spirits and living listeners gather. They permit refusal and departure; they do not carry Selaen or define Vesh anatomy.

The Duskbreak disrupted the places and histories to which many spirits belong. Vesh keepers now face the same dimming as every people, with the added duty of hearing presences that communities may no longer recognize. The Ashen Choir exploits the desire to preserve them by promising a final harmony.

In the Quieting, distinct spirits begin repeating one account as the Choir forces their voices toward the Onefold Vault. Lanternrest investigates the lost differences, Selaen must choose which endangered community it can reach, and Nhalen and Saeril confront the cost of treating guidance as

certainty. The world storyline and character arcs define the connected narrative.

Character Presentation Contracts

Appearance Data

Appearance uses common identity fields plus a race-discriminated feature set. The server validates each saved combination.

Common appearance categories are:

- race;
- sex: male or female;
- curated body preset;
- constrained visual-height preset;
- age-presentation preset;
- face preset;
- skin tone (surface tone for Kell; coat tone for Vesh);
- markings; and
- voice.

Race-specific categories are:

- **Aurin:** hair style, hair color, and hair-dye treatment.
- **Kell:** horn form, plate pattern, mineral tones, mineral finish, wear, engraving, and inlay.
- **Vesh:** hair style, coat texture, white-fur pattern, and face-surface finish. The selected coat is obsidian-black with white markings and golden eyes; alternate palette choices remain TBD.

Race-specific fields must not become nullable gameplay inputs scattered across class, faction, ability, equipment, or progression data.

Portable cultural pigments, symbols, and adornment styles belong to shared marking, cosmetic, or equipment layers. They are not locked inside one people's race-feature block.

Combat Envelope and Rig

All people and sexes share:

- one authoritative combat capsule;
- equivalent visible height and limb-reach bounds;
- one shared combat-presentation skeleton and weapon-socket alignment contract;
- one shared camera and aim-presentation anchor contract that never selects a target or originates an authoritative trace;

- identical attack traces, authored contact frames, root-motion distances, and recovery timing; and
- the same readable telegraph requirements.

Kell horn, ear, and plate attachments and any auxiliary visual bones, together with Vesh hair and fur presentation bones, serve presentation only. They may drive secondary animation and visual-only attachment sockets, but never collision, authoritative traces, the shared weapon-presentation sockets, reach, root motion, authored contact timing, or gameplay state.

Visible joint scaling remains inside the validated rig bounds. Animation warping and IK keep visible hands, weapons, feet, and attack contact aligned with the shared presentation sockets, root motion, ground plane, and authored contact frames for every approved body and height preset. Sockets visualize that server-owned timeline; they never establish a hit volume, window, contact, or selected target.

Exact capsule dimensions, visual-height limits, and skeleton measurements remain TBD until the combat prototype validates the reference body.

Equipment Presentation

One equipment item has one gameplay identity, stat definition, and eligibility rule. Its visible fitting set uses race-and-sex-specific bases plus the morphs, feature accommodations, or additional visual variants needed for every approved body, height, horn, plate, hair, fur, and natural-face combination.

Each people defines stable visual attachment roots and protected fit envelopes for required anatomy. Exact measurements remain TBD with the reference rigs, but equipment may not intrude into those envelopes or move them to imply a different combat surface.

- Helmets accommodate Aurin hair, Kell horns and external ears, and the Vesh natural face and hair without removing biological anatomy.
- Shoulder, chest, and collar pieces fit Kell plate contours and neck movement.
- Gauntlets and boots accommodate Kell claws, thumb articulation, and three-toed feet while preserving shared grips and foot placement.
- Vesh gauntlets fit two clawed fingers and a thumb. Boots fit the digitigrade lower leg and enclose the three-toed paw without deleting toes or claws. Preserve shared grip sockets, foot placement, and ground contact.
- Vesh collars, cloaks, and back equipment accommodate coat and hair volume; preserve the visible neck and modest forward shoulder set. No back-veil accommodation is required by the revised anatomy.
- Biological structures never retract, disappear, or become armor to solve equipment fitting.
- Cultural appearances are wearable by every people through fitted variants.
- A visible equipment set is not ready for supported character creation until its extreme supported preset combinations pass clipping and animation review.

Animation Presentation

Each people receives a full visual movement identity through shared gameplay sources plus race-specific base poses, transitions, secondary motion, and additive layers.

Animation variation must not change alignment with authored contact frames, weapon-presentation sockets, authoritative traces, camera or aim-presentation anchors, root-motion distances, recovery timing, or readable telegraphs. Male and female presentation may differ within the same rule.

Visibility and Accessibility

Vesh eye light, Kell crystal and eye light, and Kell mineral reflectivity are presentation-normalized. Exposure, distance LOD, and common combat-readability rules must prevent race from creating a visibility, targeting, tracking, or concealment advantage.

Vesh golden eye light uses one authored luminance envelope across expression and LODs. Coat color, white pattern, and fur detail remain readable under common exposure rules; they cannot create a concealment or tracking advantage. Player choices cannot disable the eye light or exceed its envelope. Kell crystal and eye light likewise use a bounded authored luminance envelope; appearance choices cannot turn biological glow off or make it a spotlight. Exact values remain TBD. Accessibility and graphics settings may change presentation only if the result preserves equivalent identification and tracking opportunity across all peoples.

Color alone must not communicate required emotion, faction, hostility, or combat state.

Art Validation Gate

A playable-people concept is not approved for production until review includes:

- front, side, and back adult turnarounds for male and female Aurin, Kell, and Vesh;
- shared-capsule, limb-reach, skeleton, and weapon-presentation-socket overlays;
- the broad body-preset range inside the constrained height envelope;
- extreme supported body, height, age, horn, plate, hair, fur, and face combinations;
- grayscale silhouettes at representative gameplay-camera distance;
- all supported class weapon grips and representative contact poses;
- camera, aim-origin, hand, weapon, foot-plant, and authored-contact alignment;
- fitted helmet, shoulder, chest, cloak, and back-equipment stress cases;
- horn, ear, plate, claw, fur, natural-face, hair, and cloth clipping checks in locomotion and combat;
- facial expression, eye behavior, voice presentation, and facial-rig checks across every face preset; use mouth visemes where the anatomy supports them. Vesh mouth motion must preserve the rigid natural face and creature opening without adding human lips, a nose, or visible teeth;

- Vesh digitigrade locomotion, clawed grips, enclosed boots, and ground contact inside the shared skeleton, reach, root-motion, and contact-timing contract;
- low-light and high-exposure checks for Vesh eye light, fur contrast, and Kell crystal surfaces, inner radiance, and glowing eyes;
- LOD checks that preserve identity without changing combat readability; and
- examples showing each people outside its heritage clothing and in both faction presentations once final faction heraldry exists.

Reject any concept that implies different hitboxes or reach, hides mandatory anatomy to fit equipment, maps race to faction, or revives a prohibited stock fantasy or animal-head silhouette.

Decisions Still Open

Do not invent:

- exact lifespan years;
- final Kell hand digit topology, grip deformation, and alternate mineral or glow-color options;
- Vesh physiology beyond the established mortal embodied form, exact face, hair, coat and marking option ranges, grip deformation, and alternate coat or eye-color choices;
- exact body, capsule, skeleton, or visual-height measurements;
- exact protected fit-envelope, joint-scaling, IK, and luminance measurements;
- the number of presets or options for any common or race-specific appearance category;
- final faction names, colors, heraldry, or race-specific faction styling;
- final language grammar or complete naming lexicons; or
- production budgets and release quantities for fitted equipment and animation variants.

These decisions remain TBD until their owning design or prototype evidence resolves them.